

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 879

By Massey

A RESOLUTION to honor Don Lindsey, 2026 Community Volunteer recipient of the John J. Duncan Sr. Award for Senior Advocacy.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should salute those citizens who, through their extraordinary efforts, have distinguished themselves as community leaders of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such individual is Don Lindsey of Knoxville, who was recently named the 2026 Community Volunteer recipient of the John J. Duncan Sr. Award for Senior Advocacy; and

WHEREAS, the John J. Duncan Sr. Award for Senior Advocacy was created to honor those who steadfastly work to improve the lives of seniors in the Knoxville community, as the award's namesake did throughout his career; recipients are professionals and community members who have been nominated in recognition of their tireless efforts on behalf of seniors; and

WHEREAS, Don Lindsey has made a significant impact in the Knoxville community over the years through his work with AAA East Tennessee, the Knox County Health Department, and numerous other governmental and public service organizations; and

WHEREAS, during his nearly forty-year career with AAA East Tennessee, Don Lindsey conducted numerous traffic safety, public affairs, and public relations programs in cooperation with local, state, and national groups; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Lindsey was an important member of the AAA team that founded the groundbreaking Volunteer Assisted Transportation program that has helped thousands of people during its nearly seventeen years in operation; he continues to serve as a member of its advisory board; and

WHEREAS, in 2006, he was instrumental in Knoxville being selected as one of the nine pilot sites for the new CarFit national program that helps seniors achieve greater comfort, safety, and confidence in driving in their cars, and he has coordinated or assisted with more than sixty training programs and other events for the program since that time; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Lindsey retired from AAA in 2016, and with the backing of his former employer, he quickly became a vital contributor to the vibrant senior support and public service community in Knoxville; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Lindsey is active with the Knox County Health Department's Senior Safety Task Force and its fall prevention awareness programs and the Task Force's Stay Active and Independent for Life program, which has helped thousands of seniors gain greater strength and improved balance; and

WHEREAS, truly a public servant of the highest order, Mr. Lindsey continues to volunteer with AARP, the Metro Drug Coalition, the Front Page Foundation, and the Tennessee Commissioner of Health's Council on Injury Prevention; he is also a past president and board member of the Optimist Club of Knoxville; and

WHEREAS, prior to his career with AAA, Mr. Lindsey worked ten years as a disc jockey and news reporter at radio stations WSEV in Sevierville and WBIR in Knoxville; and

WHEREAS, his many professional and personal accomplishments aside, Don Lindsey is most grateful for the love and companionship he shares with his three children and four grandchildren; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Lindsey's involvement in senior and other community organizations speaks volumes about his commitment to making Knoxville a better place for everyone, particularly those who are most vulnerable; and

WHEREAS, Don Lindsey's lifelong dedication to service is a testament to the impact one person can have on a community; he has left an indelible mark on Knoxville by acting on his steadfast belief in the power of giving back; and

WHEREAS, as Knoxville continues to grow and evolve, the foundation that Mr. Lindsey has helped build will remain a guiding light for future generations; his legacy exemplifies his deeply rooted desire to make the world a better place; and

WHEREAS, Don Lindsey is most worthy of our approbation on this special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate Don Lindsey, 2026 Community Volunteer recipient of the John J. Duncan Sr. Award for Senior Advocacy, extending our best wishes for his continued success as he compassionately and devotedly serves his community and its senior citizens.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.